

will look on the Internet and on your hard disk to try and find a suitable driver; you'd choose the latter ("specific location") if you have a CD-ROM, for example, with the updated drivers.

The wizard then asks you specific questions based on the outcome of the search in the former case, and in the latter case, you're usually prompted to point Windows to the precise location of the driver files.

Disable is used to temporarily disable a device, if, for example, you never use the device and want to speed up startup times, or if you want to do advanced troubleshooting.

Uninstall removes the device from your system. This comes in handy if you want to re-install a device, for example.

Scan for Hardware Changes is used when, for example, you get a message like "The driver for this device might be corrupted, or your system may be running low on memory or other resources." In such a case, you would uninstall the driver and scan for new hardware to install the driver again. (More on uninstalling drivers later.)

Properties is the most frequently used option. Since, in this limited space, we can't tell you about the properties of every type of device, we'll use examples.

9.3.1 Examples Of Device Properties

Say you select the properties of a hard disk. You'll see a box with five tabs, as below:

Let's look at the 'Policies' tab. Here, you have an option to "enable write caching" on the disk. If it is not already selected, enabling this can improve the disk's performance by making the transferring of data between the drive and the memory more efficient. The only reasons not to enable this setting would be if the drive in question is in a hot-swappable drive rack, or if you expect